

短文 1

Good morning, everyone. Many students spend hours looking at books and screens, so today I'd like to share three tips on protecting your eyes. First, follow the 20-20-20 rule: every 20 minutes, look at something 20 feet away for 20 seconds. Second, keep your book about 30 centimeters from your eyes, and study in good light. Third, spend two hours outdoors every day, because natural light is good for your eyes. Try these tips, and your eyes will thank you.

短文 2

Hello, everyone. Today I'd like to introduce Chinese paper cutting, a traditional folk art with a history of more than 1,500 years. With just scissors and red paper, artists can create flowers, animals and lucky characters. During the Spring Festival, people stick paper cuttings on windows and doors to welcome good luck. In 2009, this art was added to UNESCO's list of intangible cultural heritage. Today, many schools offer paper-cutting classes, so the old art is still full of life.

短文 3

Hi, everyone. Bees are small, but they do a big job. They carry pollen from flower to flower, which helps plants grow fruit and seeds. However, bee numbers have been falling in many places. The main reasons are the loss of wild flowers and the use of chemicals on farms. The good news is that people are taking action. Farmers are using fewer chemicals, and cities are planting more flowers. You can help too: grow some flowers on your balcony.

短文 4

Good afternoon, everyone. When you want to remember a text, do you read it again and again? A study by researchers at an American university suggests a better way.

In the study, students read a short science passage. One group read it four times. The other group read it only once. Then, without looking at the passage, they wrote down everything they could remember, and they did this three times.

Five minutes later, the reading group remembered more. But one week later, the result was the opposite. The recall group remembered about 60 percent of the passage, while the reading group remembered only 40 percent.

Why? Reading again feels easy, so we think we have learned the text. But pulling information out of our memory is hard work, and this hard work makes the memory stronger.

So next time, close your book and try to retell what you have read.

短文 5

Hi, I'm Zhang Wei. A year ago, speaking English was my biggest problem. In my first speaking test, I stopped in the middle of my retelling because I forgot what came next. I got only four points out of nine, and I felt terrible.

My teacher, Ms. Chen, gave me three pieces of advice. First, read aloud for ten minutes every morning. Second, after reading a short passage, close the book and retell it in my own words. Third, record my voice and listen for my mistakes.

At first, it felt strange to hear my own voice, but I kept going. Three months later, I could retell a whole passage without stopping, and in the next test, I got eight points.

Now I know that speaking is a skill, just like swimming. You can't learn it by watching others. You have to practice every day, even when it feels hard.